NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

MIL-B-3461G
INT. AMENDMENT 5 (USA)
14 March 2002
USED IN LIEU OF
AMENDMENT 4
15 July 1993

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BUTTON, INSIGNIA, METAL, UNIFORM AND CAP

This interim amendment is approved for use within all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense with MIL-B-3461G.

PAGE 1

Paragraph 1.2:

Under “Type I, Style I - Air Force, Silver Plated,” **add**:
“Class A - Air Force (with coat of arms design)"
"Class B - Air Force (with wings and star design)"

PAGE 2

Under “Type I, Style 3, Class A, Subclass 1,” **delete**:
“(Officers)”
“Subclass 2” in its entirety.

Under "Type 1, Style 4," **add**:
"Class D - Nickel Plated, Gold Plated, Mirror-like Polished"

Under “Type II, Style 3, Class A, Subclass 1,” **delete**:
"(Officers)"
"Subclass 2" in its entirety.

Under "Type II, Style 3, Class B, Subclass 1," **delete**:
"(Officers)"
"Subclass 2" in its entirety.

Under "Type II, Style 4," **add**:
"Class D - Nickel Plated, Gold Plated, Mirror-like Polished"

Under "Type II, Style 5, Class A," **add**:
"Subclass 1 - Male"
"Subclass 2 - Female"

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Paragraph 1.2.1:

Delete TABLE I in its entirety and **substitute** the following TABLE I:

TABLE I. **Button sizes (in lignes)**. **1**/

ARMY	AIR FORCE	MARINE CORPS	NAVY	COAST GUARD	COAST GUARD AUX	ARMY JROTC	ARMY SPECIAL 2/	ARMY CORPS OF ENGRS
20	20	--	--	--	--	--	--	--
--	--	22	--	--	--	--	--	--
--	--	--	22-1/2	22-1/2	22-1/2	--	--	--
25	25	--	--	--	--	25	25	25
--	--	27	--	--	--	--	--	--
--	--	--	28	28	28	--	--	--
30	30	--	--	--	--	30	--	30
--	--	--	35	35	35	--	--	--
36	36	--	--	--	--	36	36	36
--	--	40	40	40	--	--	--	--
--	45 **3**/	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

1/ A tolerance of ± 1 ligne will be permitted.
2/ Army Special buttons are restricted for use by the United States Army Band and Ceremonial Units of the U.S. Army 3d Infantry.
3/ Air Force uses 45 ligne buttons only for Type I, Style 1, Class A buttons.

Section 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

Delete Section 2 in its entirety and **substitute** the following for Section 2:

"2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS

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A-A-52094 - Thread; Cotton

FEDERAL STANDARDS

FED-STD-151 - Metals, Test Methods
FED-STD-595 - Colors Used in Federal Procurement

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of the above specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Document Order Desk, DODSSP, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094. Or visit the DODSSP web site at http://astimage.daps.dla.mil for online access to standardization documents.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY DRAWINGS

4-4-92 - Buttons, Insignia, Metal, Uniform and Cap (also illustrated as Figure 1)
B-6-5 - Button, ROTC, JR Division (also illustrated in Figure 3)
B-6-10 - Buttons, USAF, US Navy, US Coast Guard, and US Marine Corps (also illustrated in Figure 2)
B-6-10A - Button, US Air Force
Buttons, Insignia, Metal, Uniform; Coast Guard Auxiliary (Figure 4)

(Reduced size copies of the above drawings are included in the specification to illustrate the different types, styles, classes, and construction of buttons. Full size versions of TIOH numbered drawings only can be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY U.S. ARMY STANDARD METAL FINISH CHIP SET

(The metal chip set can be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.3 Non-Government publications and references. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DoDISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DoDISS are issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

(Non-government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other information services.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY CONTROL

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 1993 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(This standard can be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control, 611 East Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53202.)

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-B-487 - Metal and Oxide Coating Thickness by Microscopical Examination of a Cross Section, Measurement of

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

2.4 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained."

PAGE 4

Paragraph 3.3.1:

Delete Table II in its entirety and **substitute** the following Table II:

TABLE II. **Copper content of copper base alloys.**

ALLOY	COPPER
Yellow Brass	64.0%-68.5%
Red Brass	84.0%-86.0%
Gilding Metal	94.0%-96.0%
Free Cutting Brass	60.0%-63.0%
Bronze	89.0%-91.0%
Nickel Brass	63.0%-65.5%
Nickel Silver	63.0%-65.5% **1**/
Low Brass	78.5%-81.5%

1/ When nickel silver is used as a base material, the nickel content shall be not less than 18%.

PAGE 5

Paragraph 3.3.2

Delete in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

3.3.2 Gold plating.

3.3.2.1 24 karat gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 24 karat unless otherwise specified.

3.3.2.2 22 karat gold for plating. Gold for plating Army buttons shall be 22 karat with nickel underplating..

Paragraph 3.3.4 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.3.4 Solder

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3.3.4.1 Hard Solder. Hard solder shall be a silver alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 1075 degrees Fahrenheit (561.7 degrees Celsius).

3.3.4.2 Soft Solder. Soft solder shall be a lead-tin alloy solder having a melting point of not less than 375 degrees Fahrenheit (190.58 degrees Celsius)."

Paragraph 3.3.5 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.3.5 Enamel. The enamel for Type II, Style 3, Class B buttons shall be a flat, synthetic, baking enamel pigmented to the shade of black matching Color Chip Number 37038 of FED-STD-595."

Paragraph 3.3.6 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.3.6 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale, clear synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquer shall not be permitted except when a macublack oxidized finish is used."

Add paragraph 3.3.7 as follows:

"3.3.7 Nickel for plating. Nickel for plating shall be the nickel plating normally used in commercial practice."

Paragraph 3.5.1 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.5.1 Soldering and swedging. All soldering shall be accomplished using hard solder specified in 3.3.4.1, except that buttons with short, long, and regular shanks may be soldered using soft solder specified in 3.3.4.2. Joints shall be clean, smooth, strong, and free from burned or reduced areas. There shall be no excess solder, and all excess flux shall be removed. When hard solder is specified, hard solder specified in 3.3.4.1 shall be used. When tested as specified in 4.4.2.1, the shank shall show no break in the soldered connection, nor shall it become loose or wobbly. When tested as specified in 4.4.2.2, the soldered or swedged screw post shall not break loose or become wobbly. As an alternate, the Type I, Style 3 buttons shanks may be swedged by a cold headed process in lieu of soldering. The cold headed process shall require prior approval to ensure shanks are not loose or wobbly."

PAGE 6

Paragraph 3.6.1.2:

Add "or red brass" after "low brass" in the first sentence.
Add "All Type I, Style 3 buttons shall have a depressed back" after the last sentence.

PAGE 8

Paragraph 3.6.2:

Delete "(see 6.2)" and **substitute** "(see 3.6.2.4 and 6.2)."

Paragraph 3.6.2.2:

Add "or red brass" after "low brass" in the first sentence.
In line 6, **delete** "Except for Style 3 (Marine Corps) buttons."

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Delete last sentence.

Add paragraph 3.6.2.4 as follows:

"3.6.2.4 Cap button for United States Coast Guard female officers. All Type II, Style 5, Class A, Subclass 2 USCG 22-1/2 ligne cap buttons shall have a staple type prong attaching device. Each prong of the attaching device shall be 7/8 inch ± 1/8 inch in length and shall be formed from 0.040 inch ± 0.002 inch diameter annealed gold-colored brass wire. The attaching device shall be centered on and fused, soldered, or swedged to the back of the button so that, when the prongs are spread open, they will be horizontal to the button design."

Paragraph 3.7.1 through 3.7.1.2- **Delete** in their entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.7.1 Plating. All plating shall be by electroplating methods. The plating shall be non-porous and continuous over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through, shaded, peeled, or blistered plating. Plating shall be smooth, fine grained, adherent, and free from pits, nodules, porosity, indications of burning, excessive edge build up, and other detrimental defects. When 24 karat gold and silver plating are tested as specified in 4.4.5, the average quantity of gold or silver on selected buttons shall be not less than the amount specified in TABLE III. In addition, no one dozen buttons tested shall contain less than 90% of the quantity of gold or silver specified in TABLE III.

TABLE III. **Weight of gold and silver (grains) per dozen buttons.**

LIGNE SIZE	AIR FORCE	MARINE CORPS	NAVY & COAST GUARD	NAVY	COAST GUARD AUX		ARMY SOLID DESIGN	ARMY PIERCED DESIGN	ARMY CORPS OF ENGRS	ARMY JROTC
	SILVER	GOLD	GOLD	SILVER	GOLD	SILVER	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD	GOLD
20	6.0	----	----	----	----	----	1.0	----	----	----
20 1/	20.0	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----
20 2/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	1.5	----
20 3/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	0.5	----
22	----	0.545	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----
22-1/2 4/	----	----	1.0	7.5	1.0	4.5	----	----	----	----
25	12.0	----	----	----	----	----	1.0	----	----	----
25 2/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	1.5	1.5	----
25 3/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	0.5	0.5	----
25 5/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	0.5
27	----	0.545	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----
28	----	----	1.25	----	1.5	6.0	----	----	----	----
30	18.0	----	----	----	----	----	1.5	----	----	0.75
30 2/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	2.25	2.25	----
30 3/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	0.75	0.75	----
35	----	----	2.0	18.5	2.0	9.0	----	----	----	----
36	24.0	----	----	----	----	----	2.0	----	----	1.0
36 2/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	3.0	3.0	----
36 3/	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	1.0	1.0	---
40	----	1.51	2.5	22.5	2.5	----	----	----	----	----
45	36.0	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

1/ Cuff link button
2/ Pierced design shell
3/ Pierced design liner
4/ When the button is to be procured for use on the service cap frame or shoulder mark, the gold content

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specified shall not apply; however, the button front and rim shall be 24 karat gold electroplated.
5/ When the button is to be procured for use on the service cap, the gold content specified shall not apply; however, the button front and rim shall be 24 karat gold electroplated."

3.7.1.1 24 karat gold plating. The gold plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.3.2.1. Prior to plating, all surfaces shall be cleaned of all matter that may affect the gold plating. The use of nickel as an undercoating with 24 karat gold shall not be permitted.

3.7.1.2 22 karat gold plating. The gold plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.3.2.2. Prior to plating, all surfaces shall be cleaned of all matter that may affect the gold plating. The use of nickel as an undercoating shall be required.

3.7.1.3 Silver plating. Silver plating shall be accomplished using silver specified in 3.3.3. The silver plating shall be a minimum of 0.0003 inch thick and shall be smooth, fine grained, adherent, free from visible blisters, pits, porosity, indications of excessive build up or other defects. In case of a dispute, testing shall be conducted in accordance with ASTM-B-487.

3.7.1.4 Nickel plating of buttons. Buttons shall be plated using not less than 0.0001 inch thick nickel plate specified in 3.3.7. Testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM-B-487.

3.7.1.5. Nickel plating of washers, link, and toggles. Washers, links, and toggles (split pin, ring, or bodkin) shall be plated using not less than 0.0002 inch thick nickel plate specified in 3.3.7. Testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM-B-487.

3.7.1.6 Nickel underplating. When 22 karat gold plating or silver plating is specified, nickel underplating shall be used. The nickel underplating shall be not less than 0.00025 inch thick. Testing shall be standard commercial. In case of a dispute, testing shall be in accordance with ASTM-B-487."

PAGE 10

Paragraph 3.7.2 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.7.2 Lacquering. Except for enameled and nickel plated buttons, the fronts of all buttons shall be lacquered using lacquer specified in 3.3.6. The dry lacquer film shall be hard, continuous, level, adherent, and free from lint, dust, and other foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.4.6, the tissue paper shall not adhere to the clear lacquered surface."

PAGE 11

Paragraph 3.7.4:

Delete text in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"3.7.4 Individual finish and color requirements. The colors and finishes of the buttons are as shown in TABLE IV. When deemed necessary, a standard sample, as described in 3.1, shall be furnished by the contracting office.

Delete TABLE IV in its entirety and **substitute** the following TABLE IV:

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TABLE IV. **Finish.**

BUTTON	FINISH
Type I	
Style 1	
Class A	Silver plated, oxidized, relieved, satin finished, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Silver plated, oxidized, relieved, with a brushed satin finish on star, and a mirror-like burnished rim
Style 2	
Classes A, B, & C	Nickel plated, 22K gold plated, mirror-like polished, with a mirror-like burnished rim, and shall match TIOH Standard Metal Finish Chip Number 9 **1**/
Class D	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class E	Bright nickel plated with a mirror-like burnished rim
Style 3	
Class A	24K gold plated, polished, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Style 4	
Class A	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Bronze, oxidized, relieved, satin finished
Class C	Silver plated, oxidized, relieved, satin finished, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class D	Nickel plated, 22K gold plated, mirror-like polished, with a mirror-like burnished rim, and shall match TIOH Standard Metal Finish Chip Number 9
Style 5	
Class A	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Bronze, oxidized, relieved, satin finished
Type II	
Style 1	Silver plated, oxidized, relieved, satin finished, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Style 2	
Classes A, B, & C	Nickel plated, 22K gold plated, mirror-like polished, with a mirror-like burnished rim, and shall match TIOH Standard Metal Finish Chip Number 9 **1**/
Class D	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class E	Bright nickel plated with a mirror-like burnished rim
Style 3	
Class A	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Dull, flat, black enamel finished, and shall match Color Chip Number 37038 of FED-STD-595
Style 4	
Class A	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Bronze, oxidized, relieved, satin finished
Class C	Silver plated, oxidized, relieved, satin finished, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class D	Nickel plated, 22K gold plated, mirror-like polished, with a mirror-like burnished rim, and shall match TIOH Standard Metal Finish Chip Number 9
Style 5	
Class A	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Class B	Bronze, oxidized, relieved, satin finished
Style 6	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim
Type III	24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim

1/ At the option of the contracting office and/or the manufacturer, these buttons may be finished as follows: 24K gold plated, matte finished, polished highlights, with a mirror-like burnished rim."

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Section 4:

Delete "4. Quality Assurance Provisions" and paragraphs 4.1 through 4.3.1 in their entirety and **substitute** the following:

"4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article (see 3.2) shall be made of a completely finished item or items for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests (see 4.3.3 and 4.3.4).

b. Conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth herein, except where otherwise indicated (see 6.2). Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4.

4.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise stated, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.3.

4.3 Methods of inspection.

4.3.1 Testing of components. See TABLE V, below:

TABLE V. **Testing of components.**

COMPONENT	CHARACTERISTIC	RQM'T¶	TEST METHOD	RESULTS REPORTED AS
copper base alloy	chemical composition	3.3.1	4.4.1	nearest 1%"

Paragraph 4.3.3.1.1:

Under "Assembly" in TABLE VI, change the third defect to read - "Looseness; shell edge not closed in, securely clinching the back. (Rotation of back within closed shell shall not exceed 10 degrees maximum.)"

Paragraph 4.3.3.1.1 - **Add** the following to TABLE VI:

Examine	Defect	Classification Major (*)		Minor
Staple type prong	Not material specified.	--	--	X
	Not properly swedged or soldered.	--	--	X

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Paragraph 4.3.3.1.4 - **Delete** in its entirety.

Paragraph 4.3.4 - **Delete** the last sentence.

PAGE 19

Paragraphs 4.3.5 and 4.3.6 - **Delete** in their entirety.

PAGE 21

Paragraph 4.4.5.1 - In line 1, change "Gold content." to "24 karat gold content."

Paragraphs 4.4.6 and 4.4.6.1 - **Delete** in their entirety and **substitute** the following:

"4.4.6 Test for lacquer. At room temperature (60° to 80° Fahrenheit/15.6° to 26.7° Celsius), press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable of being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which the pressure shall be released and the item inspected to determine compliance with 3.7.2."

PAGE 22

Paragraph 4.4.8:

Delete "type 1A3 or IB3, 4 ply of V-T-276." and **substitute** "Type II, 4 ply of A-A-52094."

Section 5 - **Delete** in its entirety and **substitute** the following:

"5. PACKAGING

"5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Department or Defense Agency, or within the Military Department's System Command. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity."

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Paragraph 6.2:

Delete "(see 3.6.2)" and **substitute** "(see 3.6.2 and 3.6.2.4)."
Delete "(j)."

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Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - NU
Air Force - 11
Coast Guard - CG

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:

Navy - MC
Air Force - 84, 99
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-0084/001)

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(Also see Figure 3.)

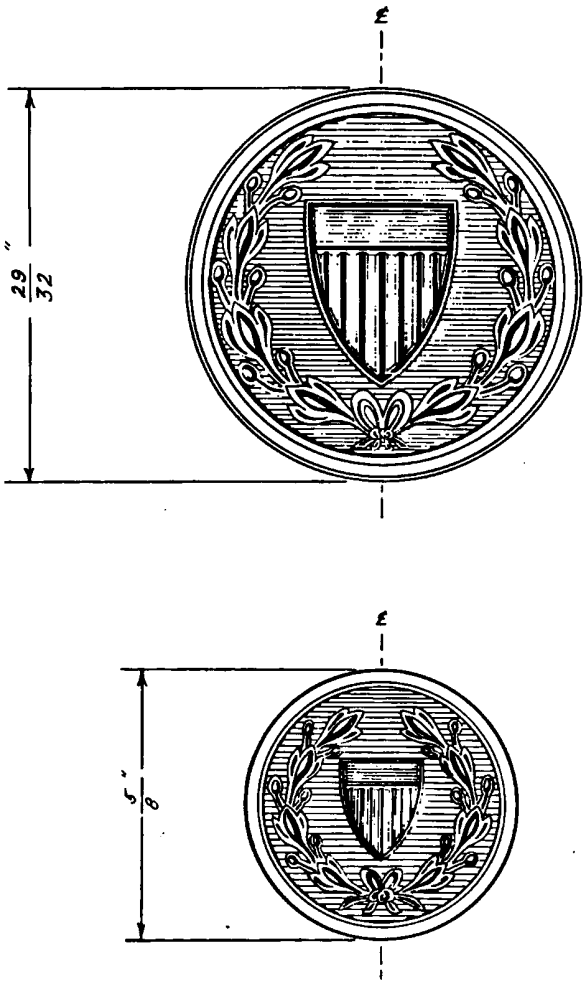
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TITLE

BUTTON, ROTC, JR DIVISION

REVISED

SCALE: 4 X ACTUAL SIZE



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THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY
U.S. ARMY

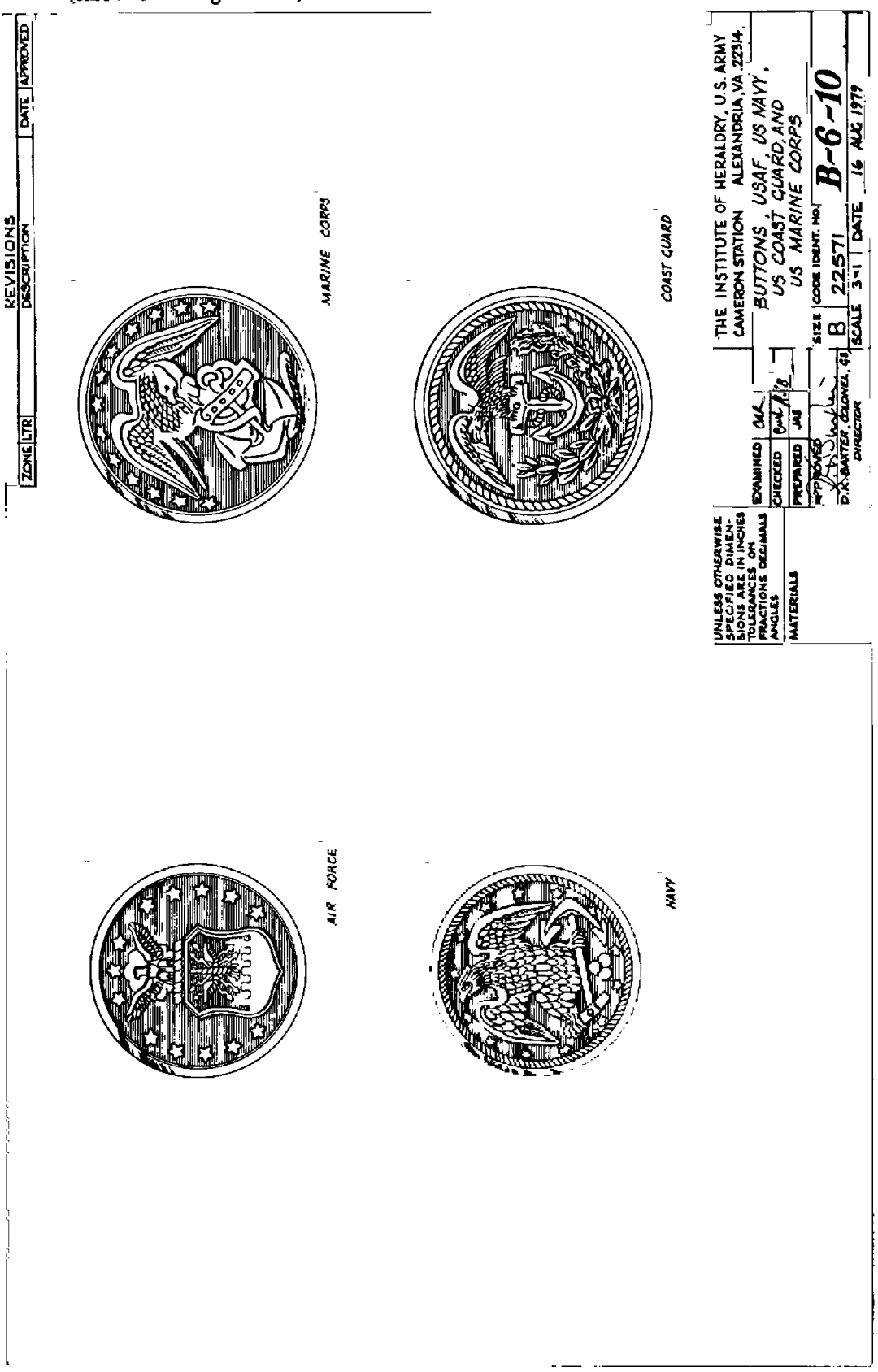
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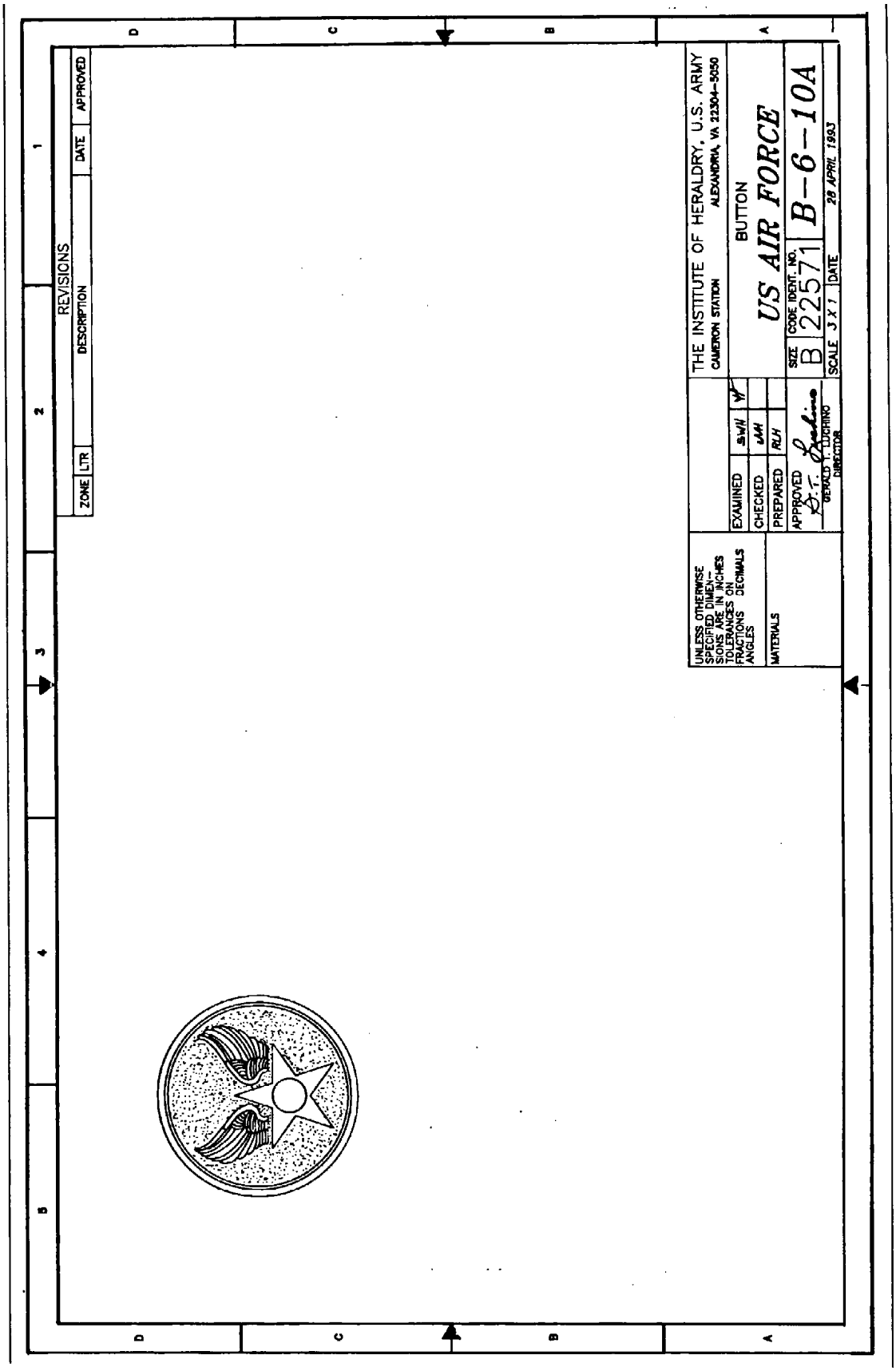
TO BE MANUFACTURED IN ACCORDANCE WITH LATEST REVISION OF SPECIFICATION MIL-B-3461.

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(Also see Figure 2.)

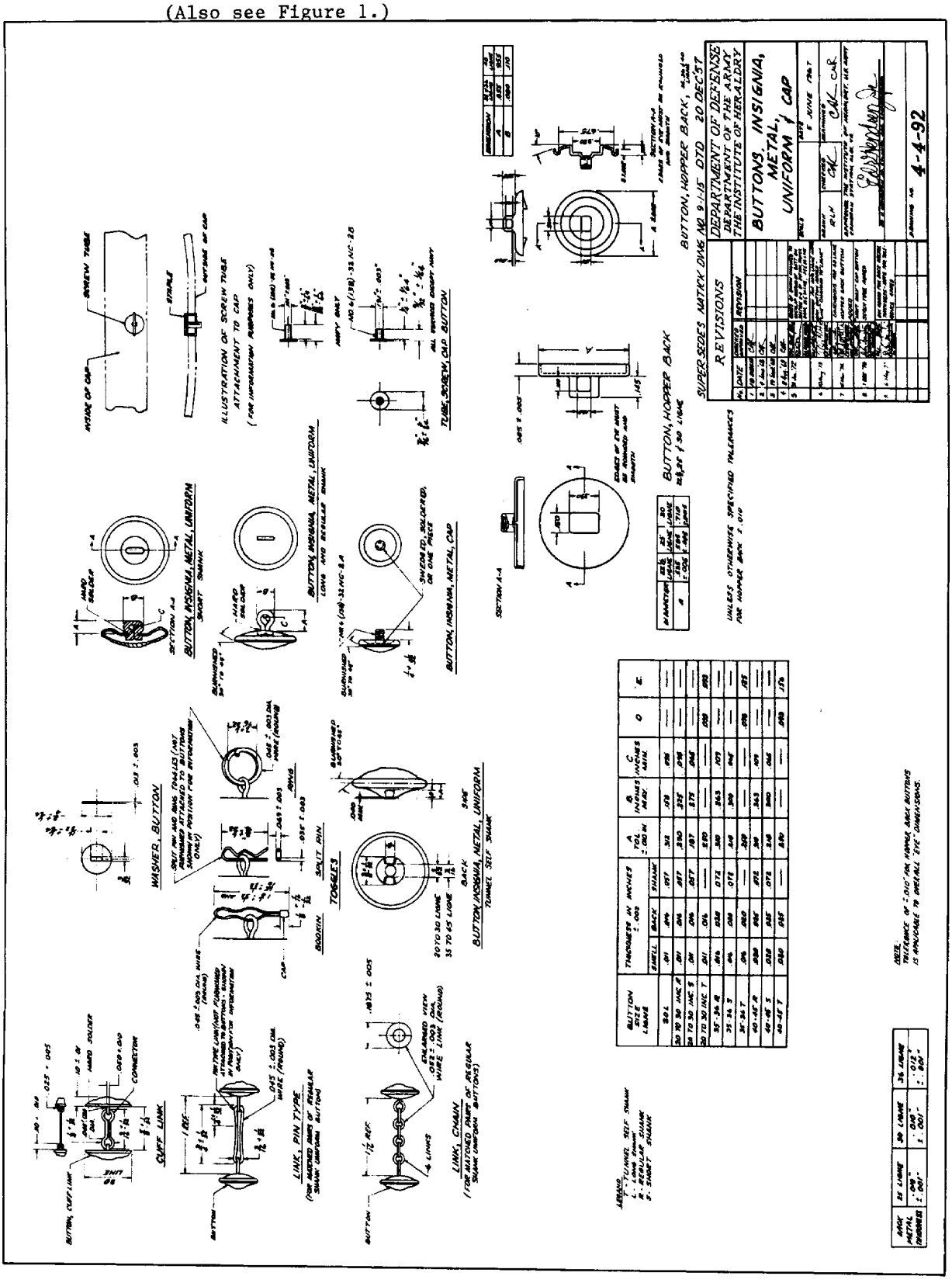


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(Also see Figure 1.)



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